ARGUMENTS IN SUPPORT OF OR IN OPPOSITION TO THE PROPOSED LAWS ARE THE OPINIONS OF THE AUTHORS

ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE A

Independent Ethics Reform.
To fight corruption and fraud, MEASURE A establishes an Independent Ethics Commission to investigate misconduct, hold public officials accountable, strictly regulate lobbyists to reduce their influence and strengthen enforcement of campaign contribution limits. Unlike other large California counties, San Diego lacks an Ethics Commission to investigate allegations of misconduct.

Full Transparency.
MEASURE A requires full and complete public disclosure of all county spending,

Independent Oversight. Accountability.
MEASURE A establishes an Independent Budget Analyst and Independent Program Auditor to track billions of taxpayer dollars, increase oversight and accountability and eliminate waste, fraud and abuse.

Holding bureaucrats accountable.
Unelected bureaucrats have too much control over the County's $8.5 billion budget with little public oversight. Under current county law, elected officials and the public cannot hold these bureaucrats accountable. MEASURE A implements accountability and transparency by requiring a public confirmation and removal process for executive-level county officials including public hearings, testimony and full public input..

Absolutely NO COST to TAXPAYERS.
MEASURE A is NOT a tax increase. MEASURE A requires implementation of all reforms using existing funds with NO NEW TAXES or additional costs to taxpayers.

Term Limits.
MEASURE A imposes strict 12-year term limits (the same as the legislature) on the Board of Supervisors.

Overdue Reforms.
Our county charter is outdated. San Diego County has a population of 3.2 million. The charter was initially adopted in 1933 when the county's population was less than 300,000. It has not been substantially updated in decades. MEASURE A makes county government more accountable and responsive to voters with stricter ethics laws to prevent corruption and fraud.

A broad, non-partisan coalition of civic, business, and labor leaders are uniting in support of MEASURE A to fight corruption, make county government more accountable, create independent budget and audit watchdogs and to better serve all of San Diego County.

Vote YES on MEASURE A.
Fight Fraud and Corruption. Increase Accountability. Require Full Transparency.

JIM ROSS
Firefighter, CALFIRE Firefighters Local #2881

PAT ZAHAROPOULOS
Director/Board, Middle Class Taxpayers Association

MIKE O'DEANE
President, San Diego Deputy Sheriffs Association

BRIGETTE BROWNING
President, San Diego & Imperial Counties Labor Council, AFL-CIO

CARIDAD SANCHEZ
City Ethics Commissioner, City of San Diego

REBUTTAL TO THE ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE A

Don't fall for deceptive window dressing on Measure A. Here is what Measure A really does: It overturns TERM LIMITS!

Bottomline: Measure A gives sitting San Diego County Supervisors a third term. Twelve years in one seat instead of eight.

MEASURE A GIVES POLITICIANS MORE TIME IN OFFICE
Sixty-eight percent of San Diego County voters set a two-term limit in 2010, by citizen initiative, with more than 70,000 neighbors signing petitions by hand. Measure A does not create a limit. It weakens the one you wrote.

MEASURE A IS PACKAGED WITH DECEPTION
In order to trick voters into throwing out current term limits, politicians confuse voters by tossing in good stuff like an ethics commission, independent auditors, and fiscal transparency. We support all three of these ideas - and the board can and should adopt these ideas on its own.

The only reason why Measure A is on the ballot is because they need to fool voters with attractive packaging into voting to throwing out the current term limits!

If the good-government reforms are genuine, they will stand on their own. Underneath the promises, this is nothing more than politicians changing the rules to give themselves more time in power.

Join us in protecting the EXISTING TERM LIMITS that voters imposed years ago.

No Kings. No Queens. No on Measure A.

JIM DESMOND
San Diego County Supervisor/Navy Veteran

CARL DEMAIO
Chairman, Reform California

STEVEN ESPARZA
Chairman, Progressive California Voter Guide

JOHNATHAN HALE
Executive Director, The Transparency Foundation

ARGUMENTS IN SUPPORT OF OR IN OPPOSITION TO THE PROPOSED LAWS ARE THE OPINIONS OF THE AUTHORS

ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE A

MEASURE A - REPEALS TERM LIMITS

In 2010, sixty-eight percent of San Diego County voters spoke loud and clear. You told the politicians to take less power, not more. You set a two-term limit for County Supervisors, and you did it the hard way, a citizen initiative where more than 70,000 neighbors signed petitions by hand. You set that rule. Not the Board.

Measure A asks you to undo it.

MEASURE A - EXTENDS TERMS OF CURRENT POLITICIANS

Three sitting Supervisors voted to place this on your ballot. It gives Supervisors a third term. Twelve years in the same seat instead of eight. The people who wrote it are the same people who get the extra time. That is not reform. That is politicians serving themselves.

MEASURE A - DISHONEST WINDOW DRESSING

They know a straight term extension would not pass on its own, so they buried it. They wrapped it in nice-sounding promises. An ethics commission. Independent auditors. Fiscal transparency. I support every one of those, and the County can do them without a charter change or extending anyone's term.

Read the ballot question closely. The extra term is not at the top. You have to look for it. That is by design. Notice the wording too. It asks whether to "set" term limits, as if none exist today. One already does, and you are the one who set it.

Every Supervisor ran for office knowing the limit was two terms. That was the deal we made with you. You should not win an election under one set of rules, then change those rules for yourself.

Strip away the packaging and this is simple. It is a power grab. Do not let them.

Vote No on Measure A - Keep Term Limits on County Politicians

The undersigned proponent(s)* or author(s)* of the Primary Argument against ballot measure A at the Midterm General election for the San Diego County to be held on November 3, 2026 hereby state that such argument is true and correct to the best of their knowledge and belief.

JIM DESMOND
San Diego County Supervisor, Navy Veteran

CARL DEMAIO
Chairman, Reform California

STEVEN ESPARZA
Chairman, Progressive California Voter Guide

JOHNATHAN HALE
Executive Director, The Transparency Foundation

REBUTTAL TO THE ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE A

Don't be fooled!
MEASURE A's opponents are wealthy Special Interests, Lobbyists, and Insiders.

Lobbyists and Special Interests want to prevent establishment of an Ethics Commission that would fight fraud and corruption, and investigate/regulate insider special interests.

Measure A is the measure Lobbyists, Insiders, and Special Interests fear most!

Don't be fooled!
MEASURE A is the most far-reaching Ethics Reform of county government in a generation. Read MEASURE A for yourself.

MEASURE A establishes an Independent Ethics Commission to fight fraud, misconduct and corruption. San Diego is the only large California County without an Ethics Commission.

MEASURE A requires full and complete public disclosure of all county spending.

MEASURE A creates an Independent Budget Analyst and an Independent Auditor to serve as "Public Watchdogs" of the County's $8.5 billion budget, increasing transparency and accountability, and exposing waste and mismanagement.

MEASURE A holds unelected bureaucrats accountable by allowing open public hearings to confirm and remove high level county officials.

MEASURE A does NOT repeal term limits. MEASURE A lets voters impose a 3-term limit (the same as the Legislature) for Supervisors. No Supervisor is being "given" an extra term. Every 4 years, Supervisors face the voters who decide if they've earned a new term or not.

Don't be fooled!
MEASURE A is opposed by Lobbyists, Insiders and wealthy Special Interests.

MEASURE A is supported by a non-partisan coalition of civic, business, and labor leaders who created MEASURE A to increase oversight, impose accountability, and fight fraud and corruption.

Vote YES on Measure A.

JIM ROSS
Firefighter, CALFIRE Firefighters Local #2881

PAT ZAHAROPOULOS
Director/Board, Middle Class Taxpayers Association

GABRIEL MARKOFF
Former Assistant District Attorney

BRIGETTE BROWNING
President, San Diego Labor Council, AFL-CIO

CARIDAD SANCHEZ
City Ethics Commissioner, City of San Diego